

Chapter 56-1

Shen Hui's appearance startled both of them.

Xu Qingzhu had never seen her before and didn't recognize her, but from what she said, she could tell that her relationship with Zhao Xuning was not simple.

She had heard Bai Weiwei mention before that Zhao Xuning had an ex-girlfriend.

She'd heard that their love was deeply engraved in their hearts, causing Zhao Xuning to never be able to move on.

Only an ex who didn't part on good terms could say such things. Xu Qingzhu immediately explained: "You might have misunderstood, we're not a couple."

Shen Hui raised an eyebrow, her every frown and smile radiating charm.

It was a kind of charm tinged with coldness, yet it didn't make anyone feel offended at all.

Anyone who saw her would be momentarily lost in thought.

Simply because of her temperament and beauty.

This kind of beauty wasn't something that looks alone could determine—it was that kind of lofty temperament that didn't make people feel annoying.

It was an arrogance that made people instinctively submit.

Xu Qingzhu was inwardly amazed by this woman's beauty, but showed no expression on her face, remaining calm and indifferent as always. "I'm already married."

She said this while showing her ring.

But Shen Hui smiled with curved lips: "If you're married, then I'd advise you to stay away from certain people."

Xu Qingzhu was puzzled: "What do you mean?"

"Some people are not picky about what they eat¹." Shen Hui said meaningfully: "You might be innocent, but some people aren't."

"Shen, Hui." Zhao Xuning almost gritted her teeth as she called out this name, saying word by word: "This is a hospital."

"So what?" Shen Hui raised an eyebrow, still acting recklessly: "Can't I speak?"

She stared intently at Zhao Xuning, as if the moment Zhao Xuning denied it, her palm could slap Zhao Xuning's face.

Even Xu Qingzhu quietly moved toward the edge, afraid of being caught up in the crossfire between them.

She thought Zhao Xuning would respond very firmly.

After all, this was Zhao Xuning's workplace, a place that was sacred and inviolable to her. No matter who caused trouble here, they would receive Zhao Xuning's cold face.

But the usually calm and rational Zhao Xuning, who was normally abnormally composed, just glanced over. Across several meters, that gaze was lingering and entangled, her voice softening, only able to say without any lethal force: "Don't make trouble."

It seemed like acting coquettish².

Also seemed like begging for mercy.

It wasn't the kind of begging from being beaten or threatened.

It was more like the tender banter between young lovers.

Xu Qingzhu's eyes nearly fell out of their sockets. She swallowed, and in this quiet environment, it sounded particularly clear.

So both pairs of eyes looked over at her.

Xu Qingzhu's heart tightened, and she immediately said: "You two talk, I'll go check on my wife."

After saying this, she immediately walked toward the hospital room.

After she entered the room, this section of the corridor became quiet. Not far away were other hospital rooms, with people coming and going in the hospital, various sounds all mixed together.

But only their area seemed to have a line drawn around it.

Completely out of place with the entire world.

Shen Hui had both hands in her coat pockets, standing straight.

Zhao Xuning was the first to walk toward her. She was slightly taller, looking at Shen Hui, her voice softer than usual, that clear and cold tone carrying a few notes of tenderness, saying in a low voice: "How did you come here?"

Shen Hui raised an eyebrow, sharply asking back: "Can't I come?"

"You can." Zhao Xuning also had both hands in her white coat pockets, with a somewhat submissive meaning, saying softly: "Want to have a drink?"

Shen Hui snorted lightly: "Do you think I came to reminisce with you?"

"No matter what it's for." Zhao Xuning said: "You have time for a drink together, right?"

"No." Shen Hui firmly refused, then frowned: "Doctor Zhao, you're still like this—showing interest everywhere, being caring everywhere."

Zhao Xuning was helpless: "I don't, it's because of you..."

"Because of me what?" Shen Hui interrupted her words, sneering: "Because of me you show interest everywhere? Or are you saying that because you were hurt by me, you go everywhere talking about your pain to attract women's attention?"

Zhao Xuning: "I don't. Shen Hui, can you listen to me properly?"

"Sorry." Shen Hui said coldly: "You no longer have the qualification to make me listen to you properly."

Zhao Xuning was momentarily speechless.

She looked at Shen Hui with eyes full of lingering love, her eye sockets slightly red. Even though Shen Hui was being so harsh with her, she didn't get angry.

All she felt was a deep sense of powerlessness.

She should have known long ago that once she lost her trust, this would be the result.

Zhao Xuning couldn't help but say: "Are you not eating properly again?"

Shen Hui frowned, asking coldly: "Is that related to you?"

"You've lost weight again." Zhao Xuning ignored her coldness, only saying softly: "Will you come eat with me?"

"Zhao Xuning, can't you understand human speech?" Shen Hui looked at her viciously, those eyes like a knife, as if she wanted to pierce Zhao Xuning with a thousand holes. But when she met her gaze, she restrained herself slightly, turning her face away: "We're no longer in a relationship where we can eat together."

"Then what do you want?" Zhao Xuning asked.

Shen Hui: "....."

Her words were momentarily blocked.

Footnotes:

¹ "葷素不忌" - A Chinese idiom literally meaning "eating both meat and vegetables without discrimination," but here used metaphorically to mean someone who is not picky about romantic partners, implying promiscuity.

² "撒嬌" - A Chinese concept referring to acting cute or coquettish to get attention or affection, often used by someone in a relationship to their partner.

Author's Note: This appears to be part of Chapter 56, showing a confrontational scene between Shen Hui and Zhao Xuning in a hospital corridor, with Xu Qingzhu caught in the middle of their drama.

Chapter 56-2

As the most beautiful, coldest-natured, and most professionally capable doctor of her age group in the hospital, Zhao Xuning was called the "flower on a high peak"¹ by doctors and nurses.

And the most difficult one to pluck.

So when she and Shen Hui stood confronting each other in the hospital corridor like this, many people heard the commotion and came running, with news spreading through various group chats.

Whether they had business on this floor or not, everyone wanted to come see the excitement.

And Shen Hui had been facing away with her back turned the whole time.

The group of young nurses had already exploded into chaos.

"Wuwuwu, I just saw Doctor Zhao seemed to be crying."

"Her eyes are so red it breaks my heart."

"Is that her girlfriend? Doesn't look like it though."

"Our Doctor Zhao is single! As long as she's single, I have a chance!"

"This is the first time I've seen Doctor Zhao like this, that expression is so pitiful."

"If her interns saw this, their filter² for Doctor Zhao would probably shatter too."

"My filter for her has gotten even deeper, wuwuwu, like a poor little puppy."

"....."

"Am I the only one curious about what that lady looks like?"

"I saw her, absolutely stunning!"

"Is she an older sister or younger sister³!"

"Looks like an older sister, really, her beauty is indescribable with words!"

"That's all temperament built up with money, her whole outfit adds up to over 400,000 yuan."

"Damn! She's way out of my league!"

"....."

More and more gazes turned their way, but Zhao Xuning didn't care. She just suppressed the urge to pull Shen Hui, her sweaty palms curling and releasing in her pockets.

Seeing that Shen Hui's expression had softened somewhat, she spoke gently again: "Come eat with me, we can talk about whatever it is after we eat, okay?"

Shen Hui glanced at her, said nothing, and just turned and walked away.

Zhao Xuning immediately followed.

Because she knew that for Shen Hui, not refusing meant tacit agreement.

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Only after the two of them left did Xu Qingzhu come out of the hospital room.

Although reason told her she shouldn't be curious, people inevitably can't control their curiosity.

And the group of nurses in the corridor had already started discussing just how much Doctor Zhao could spoil someone when in love.

Someone said with envy and longing: "I really want to date Doctor Zhao."

"Forget it." Someone said with great self-awareness: "I'm not worthy of Doctor Zhao."

Everyone: "....."

That seemed about right.

Liang Shi was still unconscious, and Xu Qingzhu stayed in the hospital room for a long time.

It wasn't until nearly evening that Xu Qingzhu left the room.

She went to the restroom.

After coming out, she bent over to wash her hands, water flowing over her fingers and wrapping around every inch of her skin, but she was in a daze.

She was thinking about Zhao Xuning's question, and also thinking about Shen Hui's answer.

"If she were a completely new person, would you love her?"

"One cannot step into the same river twice."

A very philosophical conversation.

For Xu Qingzhu, she really couldn't figure it out.

Fortunately, she wasn't someone who got obsessed with such things. It was just that now that things were quiet, this question appeared in her mind.

She didn't follow Shen Hui's answer, nor did she force herself to definitely figure it out.

She just felt: let nature take its course.

Many things don't necessarily need answers, especially when it comes to emotions.

So what if there were answers?

Ninety percent of things in this world can be completed independently, so one should think of firm goals and find the right direction. But only emotions—they need two people to construct.

It's not something one person can decide alone.

No matter how much she agonized over it, it would be meaningless.

Moreover, the most important thing right now was Minghui Jewelry.

In this regard, she thought very clearly.

Just as she was lost in thought, a clear voice sounded beside her ear: "The water is overflowing."

Only then did Xu Qingzhu come to her senses, discovering that the water in the sink had already overflowed. She immediately turned off the faucet and pressed down the drain.

Clear water flowed down through the drain.

She said warmly: "Thank you."

But when she saw the other person's face, she was momentarily stunned.

"It's you." Xu Qingzhu said in a lowered voice, with a hint of disbelief.

"Mm." Without Zhao Xuning around, Shen Hui bore no hostility toward her, only answering in a very casual tone: "It's me."

Footnotes:

¹ "高嶺之花" - A Japanese-origin idiom meaning "flower on a high peak," referring to someone who is beautiful/excellent but unattainable or out of reach.

² "濾鏡" - Literally "filter," but in internet slang refers to having a good impression or idealized view of someone.

³ In Chinese culture, it's common to refer to women as "姐姐" (older sister) or "妹妹" (younger sister) based on apparent age or as terms of endearment, regardless of actual relationship.

Chapter 56-3

After washing her hands, Shen Hui took out two sheets of paper from the side, unhurriedly wiping her fingers.

Her fingers were very pale, slender and long. Her nails weren't very long and had no manicure, looking beautiful and clean.

After finishing everything, she noticed that Xu Qingzhu was staring at her intently, then curved her lips in a smile: "Do I have something on my face?"

"No." Only then did Xu Qingzhu come back to her senses, letting out a light laugh and praising with very sincere tone: "You're too beautiful, I was lost in thought looking at you."

"Oh?" Shen Hui was surprised. She pointed at the mirror: "Hasn't your own face raised the upper limit of your aesthetic standards?"

Xu Qingzhu was speechless.

The two weren't acquainted, having only met once before.

But after wiping her hands, Shen Hui handed Xu Qingzhu a compact powder.

Xu Qingzhu was confused: "What does this mean?"

Shen Hui pressed the side of her own neck: "Look in the mirror."

Only then did Xu Qingzhu turn around. When she turned her face to the side, she saw a purple bruise mark on the right side of her neck.

—A hickey¹.

Her eyes showed panic—this was the first time she'd encountered such a situation.

Somewhat shameful.

But Shen Hui said: "Just cover it up."

Xu Qingzhu took out the compact powder, pressing a thick layer on her neck, but her skin was fair and the powder couldn't cover it completely.

Plus, in her panic, most of the powder scattered to other places.

Shen Hui couldn't bear to watch. She took the compact from her hands, pressed her finger on the powder puff, then pressed it on the back of her hand and shook off the excess before moving closer to Xu Qingzhu.

The sudden approach of a stranger made Xu Qingzhu somewhat nervous. She couldn't adapt to this kind of sudden closeness.

Even her breathing stopped.

Shen Hui noticed her tension and immediately stepped back half a step, retreating to a safe distance that would put her at ease.

"I'm an Omega." Shen Hui said: "So I don't mean to flirt with you."

Her voice was cold but without hostility.

Xu Qingzhu knew she had misunderstood and immediately explained: "I know, it's my own problem. I can't adapt to this kind of intimate distance."

"Then what about the hickey on your neck?" Shen Hui said teasingly, then reached out to touch up her makeup.

Shen Hui's powder had good coverage and her technique was also good.

She covered the hickey about seventy to eighty percent.

But to completely hide it was simply impossible.

Even so, unless you looked closely, you couldn't tell.

Xu Qingzhu thanked her.

Shen Hui put away the compact, saying very casually: "No problem, I've always liked pretty girls."

Xu Qingzhu felt like she had just been flirted with, but then Shen Hui said: "Consider it compensation for hurting you just now. Sorry, I didn't mean to hurt you."

She was simply hurting Zhao Xuning.

Xu Qingzhu replied: "It's okay, but may I ask what your relationship with Doctor Zhao is?"

Shen Hui paused: "Must I answer?"

"....."

Shen Hui asked that question very seriously, without any fluctuation, yet it inexplicably gave off a sense of pressure.

Xu Qingzhu was about to say it wasn't necessary when Shen Hui said: "If I had to summarize, then probably—"

"Enemies who've rolled in the sheets²."

Footnotes:

¹ "草莓印" - Literally "strawberry mark," Chinese slang for hickey due to the reddish-purple color resembling a strawberry.

² "滾過床單的仇人" - A crude but common Chinese internet slang meaning "enemies who have had sexual relations," implying a complicated relationship between former lovers who now hate each other.

Chapter 56-4

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Liang Shi woke up at night. The night was dim, with lights shining outside, while what met her eyes was a miserable expanse of white.

Her head was splitting with pain, as if her brain was about to explode.

It took a long while for her to recover.

As if she had experienced a battle, she lay on the hospital bed looking at the pure white ceiling, gasping heavily, then scattered memories returned to her mind.

Including her memories of going to Zheng Feiran for psychological counseling.

To be precise, it should be the original host's memories.

The original host had gone to see Zheng Feiran, been tested for mental illness, and had records of consultations and prescribed medications.

But why did she stop going later?

In the dream, those memories were very fragmented.

It was the original host constantly pulling and struggling, unwilling to show her.

And the memories of seeing Zheng Feiran weren't completely intact either—some light, harmless issues were remembered.

But regarding everything that drove her to madness, she had forgotten it all.

What was most vivid were the memories of when she passed out.

It felt as if there really were two people pulling at each other inside her body, desire and reason separated, making her unlike herself.

It seemed like only getting close to Xu Qingzhu could soothe her.

She remembered everything.

She...

Had promised Xu Qingzhu before that she wouldn't hurt her.

But it seemed she hadn't managed to keep that promise.

Liang Shi regretfully slapped her own forehead, placing the back of her hand on her forehead and letting out a heavy sigh.

She remembered all the sensations—her fingers landing on that soft place, tightly holding that slender waist, even the tip of her tongue lightly touching between her neck.

Her teeth grinding against her skin, like an unsatisfied vampire in the dark night.

.....

"Awake?" Zhao Xuning was the first to push open the door and enter, asking coldly: "Hungry?"

Liang Shi looked at her and asked familiarly: "What happened to me?"

"You were stimulated and had a susceptible period¹ episode, so..." Zhao Xuning paused, showing a death smile²: "What do you think?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She asked with slight despair: "What position should I die in to look better?"

"Don't die in the hospital." Zhao Xuning said: "Easy to get rescued."

"You could choose not to save me." Liang Shi said.

Zhao Xuning: "That would violate professional ethics."

Liang Shi: "....."

Zhao Xuning checked all her vital signs and asked with a cold expression: "What did you dream about?"

"What's wrong?"

"While you were unconscious, your brain waves showed severe fluctuations." Zhao Xuning said: "Simply put, you might have had nightmares during that time period."

Liang Shi: "....."

She didn't hide anything from Zhao Xuning, telling her about all the memories that appeared in her dream.

And Zhao Xuning asked her what it felt like when she was forcing Xu Qingzhu before losing consciousness.

Liang Shi: "....."

Guilt flourished in her heart, and she really didn't want to recall it.

Every recollection was a slap from her previous confident promises.

But Zhao Xuning asked very rigorously, hoping she could accurately describe her feelings at the time.

Liang Shi hesitated for a few seconds, then answered: "It was even harder to bear than during my first susceptible period. Back then it was just physical desire, so I could suppress that desire by hurting myself, but today it was dual pressure from both psychological and physical aspects, especially psychological. It felt like I would die if I didn't force her, like there were many ants biting my body. I urgently wanted to... with her..."

Speaking to this point, Liang Shi lowered her head and sighed, covering her face with both hands: "I'm sorry, I deserve to die."

She simply couldn't control this body.

Zhao Xuning calmly watched her guilt: "What else? Any other feelings? Was it more bodily desire or psychological pressure?"

"Psychological." Liang Shi recalled the feelings at the time, trying her best to use words to recreate those sensations: "I was extremely agitated then, only hoping to have sexual relations with someone, wanting to take more things. The images that flashed through my mind were all very brutal things, related to sex."

She spoke very euphemistically, but Zhao Xuning barely understood.

Zhao Xuning only asked her: "Do you still not have complete control over this body?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "Not yet."

Her luck value hadn't accumulated to 80 yet, so she didn't have complete usage rights to this body.

So when the original host's anxious emotions combined with the body's fearful memories, she would feel powerless.

"Then I very unfortunately have to tell you my hypothesis." Zhao Xuning said: "This body has sex addiction."

Liang Shi was surprised: "What does that mean?"

"It means she has a condition where when emotions become anxious and restless, she needs to make love with someone to relieve the anxiety." Zhao Xuning said: "From a psychological perspective, it's a manifestation of lacking security, not finding appropriate ways to vent emotions, so choosing to use sex for relief."

Liang Shi: "....."

Zhao Xuning looked at her and suddenly smiled coldly: "Do you still think you definitely won't hurt Xu Qingzhu?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She sighed: "I'm sorry."

"You didn't force yourself on me." Zhao Xuning said: "What's the use of apologizing to me? I won't forgive you on behalf of others."

Liang Shi: ".....I'm not someone who uses force."

Zhao Xuning raised an eyebrow: "Then how did you end up in the hospital?"

Liang Shi: ".....I was wrong."

Zhao Xuning was amused by her and broke character, laughing: "Alright, are you hungry? Want to go out and eat together?"

Liang Shi asked: "What about Xu Qingzhu?"

"She's outside making a phone call..." Before Zhao Xuning could finish, Xu Qingzhu's voice came from the hospital room. She stood at the doorway: "I'm here."

Liang Shi's expression froze, and she didn't dare look at her.

Zhao Xuning looked at the atmosphere between the two and very tactfully said: "You two talk first, I'll wait for you outside."

Without Zhao Xuning, the hospital room suddenly became awkward.

Footnotes:

¹ "易感期" - In ABO (Alpha-Beta-Omega) dynamics, refers to a period when Alphas become extremely susceptible to Omega pheromones and may lose control.

² "死亡微笑" - Internet slang for a fake, cold smile that doesn't reach the eyes, often used when someone is angry but trying to maintain politeness.

Chapter 56-5

Liang Shi lay on the bed like a quail.

Xu Qingzhu walked in and kept looking at her back.

After a long while, Liang Shi said in a muffled voice: "I'm sorry."

She had just woken up, her voice hoarse, sounding pitiful and wronged.

Xu Qingzhu stood there, her clear and cold voice blending with the lonely night: "What?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together. She was curled up in a ball and said again: "I'm sorry."

She simply didn't dare face her.

Having lived for twenty-five years, this was the first time she had experienced such a thing.

Her calm composure and Buddhist detachment crumbled the moment those memories surged forth. She felt like she was a beast.

If time could go back, she would definitely strangle herself at that moment.

Unfortunately...

Now she could only hide like a quail.

Xu Qingzhu's clear and cold voice revealed no joy or anger: "So?"

"I don't know." Liang Shi said in a muffled voice: "Whatever you want me to do, I can do it."

She adopted a full apologetic attitude.

But Xu Qingzhu snorted lightly: "So when you apologize to people, you turn your back to them? Where are your manners?"

Liang Shi: ".....My manners ran away from home."

Xu Qingzhu was stunned for a moment, then heard Liang Shi say in a very timid low voice: "I'm sorry."

"....."

"My ears hurt from hearing it." Xu Qingzhu said: "That's the third time already."

Liang Shi said in a muffled voice: "Sorry."

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

After a moment of silence, Xu Qingzhu said: "I suspect you're doing this on purpose."

Liang Shi explained: "I'm not."

"Then can you face me while apologizing?" Xu Qingzhu said: "That way I can decide whether to forgive you."

Liang Shi: "....."

After a long while, her body relaxed, then she turned over, burying half her head forcefully in the pillow, her eyes looking downward, but refusing to look at Xu Qingzhu no matter what.

But Xu Qingzhu immediately saw her reddened eye sockets.

Her heart couldn't help but soften.

Xu Qingzhu crossed her arms: "You feel this guilty?"

"Mm." Liang Shi pressed her lips together: "I'm really very sorry."

If it were the original host's mess, she would have accepted it.

But at that time, it was her who was controlling this body, yet she still almost hurt Xu Qingzhu.

If the misfortune value system were online, it would definitely max out her misfortune value.

Xu Qingzhu was momentarily speechless. Originally, she was really somewhat angry.

But seeing her expression and eyes, looking exactly like she had suffered some great grievance, as if she were the one who had been forced.

Xu Qingzhu's heart was filled with mixed feelings.

She let out a gentle sigh.

Before she could speak, Liang Shi said: "You can do whatever you want. We don't have to be together, or we can live separately. I'm about to move out of that villa anyway. If you want that thing¹, I can also cooperate."

The system wouldn't let her say divorce, so she avoided the sensitive word.

The system was an AI—how could it detect this kind of thing?

But some words in specific contexts, even without being spoken, could make the other party instantly understand her meaning.

So Xu Qingzhu asked back: "You want to divorce me?"

Liang Shi nodded frantically.

Xu Qingzhu clicked her tongue: "That's your ultimate goal, isn't it?"

Liang Shi: "?"

"After going through all this trouble, it's just for a divorce." Xu Qingzhu said expressionlessly: "If you wanted a divorce, you should have said so earlier. Why be so roundabout? It's not like I wouldn't cooperate."

Liang Shi widened her eyes: "No, it's just..."

She pressed her lips together, her gaze meeting Xu Qingzhu's before weakening again, looking both wronged and timid: "I'm just afraid of hurting you again."

"You had my consent." Xu Qingzhu said: "So it doesn't count as harm."

Liang Shi sat up directly, making eye contact with her, those reddened eyes seeming to say—really?

Footnotes:

¹ "那啥" - A euphemistic way of referring to something sensitive or embarrassing without saying it directly, in this context likely referring to divorce or separation.

Chapter 56-6

Xu Qingzhu shrugged indifferently: "Besides, the one who fainted in the end was you. And also, isn't it because your body is sick?"

Liang Shi: "....."

It sounded like scolding, but it was the truth.

She said dejectedly: "But I did indeed... to you..."

Xu Qingzhu suddenly laughed lightly: "Teacher Liang, are you acting?"

Liang Shi: "?"

"No!" Liang Shi denied: "I'm really feeling guilty."

"Then your apologies to me are all very insincere." Xu Qingzhu said: "I reasonably suspect you're using retreat as advance¹."

She made a sarcastic "tsk" sound: "I didn't expect that after just fainting for a bit, Teacher Liang's acting skills would improve by leaps and bounds. Now it has that flavor."

Liang Shi: ".....?"

"What flavor?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingzhu: "Green tea² flavor—using retreat as advance, saying you feel guilty but showing no action at all, making yourself look wronged, wishing the whole world could see that you're the one being wronged."

"No." Liang Shi argued: "Clearly you're the one who's most wronged."

Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow: "Really? If you hadn't mentioned it, I would have forgotten."

Liang Shi: "....."

Xu Qingzhu calmly asked back: "So why are your eyes red? What are you feeling wronged about? The person who should feel most wronged isn't even wronged, so how did you end up feeling wronged?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi was rendered speechless.

After a long while, she came to her senses and asked tentatively: "Are you comforting me in reverse?"

Xu Qingzhu glanced at her, her tone light and airy: "Our Teacher Liang isn't completely stupid after all."

Liang Shi: "....."

Xu Qingzhu's sarcastic appearance was really very...

Before Liang Shi could think of an appropriate adjective, she heard Xu Qingzhu say: "Poor little Teacher Liang, so wronged, so wronged she'd cry under the covers if no one comforted her."

Liang Shi: "....."

She couldn't help but reply: "Yes, wronged."

Xu Qingzhu's pupils contracted, as if saying—you dare to go along with this?

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, not as timid as before: "There has to be someone who feels wronged, right?"

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

"Teacher Xu doesn't feel wronged, so I'll feel wronged on Teacher Xu's behalf." Liang Shi said, mimicking Xu Qingzhu's tone.

Xu Qingzhu: "....."

Her tongue pressed against her teeth. After a moment, she laughed: "Then both I and my sense of being wronged thank Teacher Liang."

Liang Shi: "....."

"Teacher Liang is so busy yet still has time to feel wronged on my behalf." Xu Qingzhu said: "I'm truly honored."

Liang Shi: "....."

Clearly every word was a compliment, but you could hear the undertone of insult.

In terms of being sarcastic, Liang Shi had lost.

However, Liang Shi still stood up and gave her a very serious bow, sincerely apologizing: "I'm sorry."

Xu Qingzhu waved her hand: "Alright, let's go eat. No need to be so melodramatic."

Liang·Melodrama·Shi followed behind her out of the hospital room.

Zhao Xuning saw her slightly red eye sockets and couldn't help teasing: "Looking so pitiful?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Liang Shi, who had just lost a round, glared at her, strangling all her sarcasm in the cradle.

Liang Shi pretended to be very fierce: "Shut up!"

Footnotes:

¹ "以退為進" - A Chinese strategic idiom meaning "to advance by retreating," referring to a tactic of appearing weak or apologetic to manipulate others into sympathy or forgiveness.

² "綠茶" - Internet slang for "green tea bitch," referring to someone (usually women) who appears innocent and pure on the surface but is actually manipulative and scheming.

Chapter 56-7

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Regarding what Zhao Xuning said about this body having sex addiction, Liang Shi still cared about it.

She didn't dare touch things that made her anxious, and even went to see a psychiatrist.

But currently, the mental state was hers. There were some things about her that science couldn't explain clearly, so psychiatric testing was useless for her and didn't detect this condition.

Liang Shi later looked through the medical records she had gotten from Zheng Feiran that day several times but didn't find anything too abnormal.

However, the original host indeed had psychological problems.

This unhealthiness was related to everything she had suffered in the Liang family.

Most of it was caused by Qiu Zimin.

Liang Shi hadn't forgotten the dream she had before—being sent to be played with by others, while Qiu Zimin told her she did very well.

Who was the person in that memory segment?

Although the memory appeared because she saw Zhou Yi'an, Liang Shi could be certain it wasn't Zhou Yi'an.

Zhou Yi'an was still abroad at that time and couldn't have come to make deals with Qiu Zimin.

It might have been some family of higher status than the Liang family.

Qiu Zimin might have deceived and coaxed the original host for a bit of profit, or simply sent the original host to people with cruel hobbies.

Anyway, her purpose wasn't for profit but to drive the original host insane.

From a certain perspective, she had already succeeded.

That medical record also revealed that the original host had no memories from before age eight. Just like her.

So before age eight, they had been switched once.

Possibly multiple times.

She had also asked Liang Xinzhou indirectly. He said the current her was quite similar to when she was little, but after experiencing the kidnapping case, her personality became somewhat abnormal.

Liang Shi had no impression of that kidnapping case.

The original host's memories didn't contain it either.

No one gave her answers to this, and the system, that useless thing, couldn't provide any help.

After Qiu Zimin's last coma, Liang Shi hadn't returned to the old mansion. She continued going to work as usual.

The injury on her shoulder healed quickly, and she was thriving at the company.

Both Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe had come to find her, probing her attitude from the side.

She consistently said: "The relationship between mom and me isn't as simple as what you see. For specifics, you can ask mom."

But obviously, Qiu Zimin wouldn't reveal that much information to them.

Liang Shi only said to them kindly: "Even if one day I no longer carry the Liang surname, I'm still your sister, if you're still willing to acknowledge me."

She returned all the choices to them.

Liang Xinzhou also spoke heart-to-heart with her: "No matter what, I acknowledge you as my sister."

Liang Shi bumped fists with him: "Thank you, big brother. When my niece is born, I'll give her a big red envelope¹."

Liang Xinzhou laughed: "Then you'd better work hard to earn money."

"You don't need to worry about that."

Liang Shi's contact with the old mansion was limited to her two brothers and sisters-in-law. She had also made a trip to Yunfeng Mountain, but still came up empty-handed.

Not only was the Yunyin Daoist not there, even the old man who had told her fortune last time was nowhere to be found.

She didn't accept Zhao Xuning's help, but instead searched for suitable houses on various rental websites.

Constantly calculating her finances and making various plans for her future life.

When Liang Shi received her first month's salary, Hazhou City had fully entered autumn. The weather was bleak, with yellow leaves by the roadside falling all over the ground.

That day also happened to be when "Afterglow" officially released its makeup test photos² and announced the main cast, as well as when Minghui Jewelry's autumn flagship products went on sale at major counters and on their official website.

Liang Shi sent Xu Qingzhu a screenshot of her bank account notification: [Teacher Xu, are you busy? Let me treat you to dinner.]

Xu Qingzhu replied instantly: [Teacher Liang, quite a high salary.]

Liang Shi: [Not bad, barely enough to make ends meet.]

Xu Qingzhu: [I might only be free tonight.]

Liang Shi: [I know, your company's flagship products are launching today. My abilities are limited, so I'll just buy one to show my support for Teacher Xu's career.]

Xu Qingzhu: [.....]

After a long while, she sent: [I think you're being sarcastic.]

Liang Shi: [No, I'm sincere.]

Xu Qingzhu: [Then don't buy any, I've set aside a set for you.]

Set.

Not just one piece.

It was the entire collection, every piece.

Liang Shi was shocked by Xu Qingzhu's generosity, especially since their company's products weren't priced low.

They had also entered the luxury tier.

Liang Shi immediately said: [Don't! Sell them for money, I can't hold you back.]

Xu Qingzhu: [.....Then remember to transfer the payment.]

Liang Shi: [.....]

She really wasn't being polite at all.

However, Liang Shi didn't transfer the money either, planning to wait until she saw the actual items before transferring.

They agreed on dinner.

At 2 PM, "Afterglow's" official Weibo released the makeup test photos and tagged all the main actors.

To keep herself clean, Liang Shi deliberately applied for a new account.

She understood this industry thoroughly, so after the official release, she immediately went to repost, like, and comment in one go.

And Zhao Ying, to help her gain followers, directly reposted her Weibo.

But at the same time, a trending topic #Minghui Jewelry Heiress Beats People# quietly appeared and climbed higher and higher.

Until evening, this trending topic surpassed the hot search that "Afterglow" crew had bought, with a small orange #Hot# tag behind it.

At the same time, another trending topic #Minghui Jewelry Heiress Chen Liuying# also appeared in the latest searches, surpassing the #Minghui Jewelry Autumn Collection So Beautiful# trending topic.

Footnotes:

¹ "紅包" - Red envelopes containing money, traditionally given as gifts during Chinese New Year and other celebrations, especially to children.

² "定妝照" - Professional photos taken after makeup and costume fitting for a film or TV show, used for promotional purposes.